Greeneville AI Meetup

What AI Can Do for You

Thursday, November 12, 2026

Big Spring Room, Greeneville/Greene County Public Library

Jordan Last

Welcome

- I'm Jordan Last. I build software with AI agents every day.
- Tonight is for everyone. Beginners are especially welcome.
- Questions are welcome at any time, not just at the end.
- Please sign up so I can tell you about future meetups.

Slides: millillion.org/meetup/slides
Meetup page: millillion.org/meetup



Tonight

Time	
7:10	Chatbots, and a live demo
7:30	AI agents, and a live demo
8:00	Agents in every kind of knowledge work
8:05	How I check AI's work, and what I've built with it
8:35	Q&A

Part 1: Chatbots

A chatbot is a conversation with an AI

- You type (or say) a **prompt**: a question or a request.
- The AI writes back a **response**.
- It's a lot like Google: you ask, it answers.
- The difference: it writes a full answer for you, and you can keep talking to refine it.

The two main chatbots

ChatGPT
made by **OpenAI**

Claude
made by **Anthropic**

Both have free versions. Paid plans start around $20 a month.

OpenAI

- Founded in **December 2015** in San Francisco as a nonprofit research lab.
- Co-founders included **Sam Altman**, **Greg Brockman**, **Ilya Sutskever** and **Elon Musk**.
- **Sam Altman**, the CEO, dropped out of Stanford to start a company, then ran **Y Combinator**, the best-known startup accelerator.
- Released **ChatGPT** on **November 30, 2022**. It became one of the fastest-growing apps in history.

Anthropic

- Founded in **2021** by **Dario Amodei** and **Daniela Amodei**, a brother and sister, with several colleagues.
- They came from **OpenAI**: Dario was its VP of Research and led work on GPT-2 and GPT-3.
- They left to build an AI company focused on **safety**.
- Released **Claude** in **March 2023**. Their tool **Claude Code** is what I use every day, and what I'll demo tonight.

Many others

- **Google:** Gemini
- **Microsoft:** Copilot
- **Meta:** Meta AI
- **xAI** (Elon Musk): Grok
- Plus many more in the US, China and Europe

They all work the same basic way: prompt and response.

Live demo: chatbot

Try along on your phone at **chatgpt.com** or **claude.ai**.

Getting good answers

- **Give context:** who you are, what it's for, who will read it.
- **Be specific:** "two short paragraphs, friendly, no jargon."
- **Keep going:** ask for changes. It's a conversation.
- **Check what matters:** it can be confidently wrong about facts, numbers and names.
- **Protect privacy:** no passwords, account numbers or other people's private information.

Part 2: AI agents

From prompt and response to prompt and work

Chatbot

- You prompt, it responds
- You copy and paste the result
- One answer at a time

Agent

- You prompt, it **works**
- It plans, takes many steps on its own, and checks its work
- It hands you a finished result

What an agent can work with

- **Your files:** read, write and organize them
- **Your email and calendar**, if you connect them
- **Your web browser:** it can click, type and fill in forms
- **Documents:** PDFs, spreadsheets, slides
- **Software:** whole programs, websites and apps, published online

In short, it can start doing knowledge work for you.

My last year as a software engineer

A year ago

- I wrote most of my code by hand
- AI suggested lines and answered questions

Today

- Agents write most of my code
- I decide what to build and check the work
- Several agents work at once

Live demo: Claude Code

1. Make a **PDF** flyer for a local business
2. Turn it into a **website**
3. Put it **live on the internet**, right now

Any field of knowledge work

If the work happens on a computer, an agent can help do it.

- Software engineering
- Computer-aided drafting and design
- Accounting and bookkeeping
- Legal documents and contracts
- Marketing, writing and research
- Office work: forms, scheduling, data entry

Part 3: Checking AI's work

How I work with agents

1. **Deliberate and specify:** decide exactly what I want, with the AI's help
2. **Autonomous implementation:** the agent does the work
3. **Check the work:**
    - **Human review:** I read it
    - **AI review:** other AI agents read it
    - **Automated checks:** tests and tools that give the same answer every time
4. **Judge the evidence**

Becoming an agentic engineer

- My job shifts from **doing** the work to **judging the evidence** that the work is right.
- The goal: let the AI do more and more, and present me with evidence.
- That's how one person scales.

This works for any knowledge work: a contract, a drawing, a budget, a report.

The automated checks

- **Tests:** run the work against examples
- **Property-based testing:** check rules across thousands of generated cases
- **Formal verification:** a mathematical proof that the software is correct
- **Slop Refinery:** automated checks for common AI coding mistakes

What I've built with AI

- **Millillion:** millillion.org
- **Lasm:** runs Lean (a language for mathematical proofs) in JavaScript and WebAssembly
- **ProofScript:** a planned version of TypeScript with built-in proofs
- **Wasmetal:** a WebAssembly CPU in hardware

How AI helped with tonight

- The meetup website and calendar file
- The flyer and its QR code
- Finding who to contact, drafting emails, and checking the listings
- These slides, and publishing them online

Q&A

Ask anything, at any level.

Thank you

- **Sign up** to hear about the next meetup.
- **Next time:** locals presenting how they use AI in their businesses and lives. Want to present? Talk to me tonight or get in touch.
- **Contact:** millillion.org/contact

Slides: millillion.org/meetup/slides
Meetup: millillion.org/meetup